

Andrea Neyra-Nazarrett

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Fields

Organizational, Personnel, Labor, Development, Political Economy.

Affiliations

Digital Reskilling Lab, Harvard Business School
Weatherhead Center for International Affairs, Harvard University
Institute for Quantitative Social Science, Harvard University

Education

Harvard University	Cambridge, MA	2027 (expected)
<i>Ph.D. in Political Economy and Government, Economics track.</i>		
Harvard Kennedy School of Government	Cambridge, MA	2021
<i>Master in Public Policy. Fulbright–García Robles Scholar.</i>		
Instituto Tecnológico Autónomo de México (ITAM)	Mexico City	2018
<i>B.A. in Economics. Graduated with the Highest Honors.</i>		

References

Jesse Shapiro (Chair)	Emily Breza	Jorge Tamayo
jesse.m.shapiro@gmail.com	ebreza@fas.harvard.edu	jtamayo@hbs.edu

Job Market Paper

Discipline at Work: Wage Premia, Managers, and Shirking in a Large Mexican Retailer (Solo-authored)

In many jobs, effort takes the form of care: attention a firm cannot measure and a supervisor observes only imperfectly, since a lapse is caught only when someone is watching. What the firm sees is the residue—a loss it can record but not trace to any worker. Inventory shrinkage, merchandise missing from the store, is such a loss, about 1.6 percent of sales for United States retailers, on the order of grocers’ net profit margin. I study how wage premia and managerial monitoring jointly deter shrinkage when monitoring is imperfect, using administrative records from a large Mexican retailer with more than 300 stores and roughly 25,000 workers at a time. Leveraging manager rotations, I estimate each manager’s effect on shrinkage. The managers who reduce it are not better bookkeepers; they monitor: they work more shifts, including nights and weekends, are more co-present with their workers on the floor, and rework the teams they inherit. On demographic characteristics they are indistinguishable from the rest. Shrinkage also falls with the wage premium. The two reinforce each other: the same arrival reduces shrinkage more where the premium is high, a difference of 8 percentage points. A model of care in which the premium and monitoring are complements can match these facts: where the premium gives the manager’s dismissal threat something to confiscate, the same manager accomplishes more.

[Latest draft available here]

Working Papers

Training Within Firms

NBER Working Paper No. 33670, 2025

with Bryan Diaz, Julian Ramirez, Raffaella Sadun & Jorge Tamayo.

We study the organizational frictions that hinder training implementation within firms, focusing on middle managers. Using data from three large Latin American firms (a car manufacturer, a quick-service restaurant chain, and a retailer), we show that managers who promote employee development raise training take-up and performance; event-study estimates around managerial rotations show “High Training” managers increase participation by up to 60%.

What Do Good Managers Do and What Do They Leave Behind?

2026

with Achyuta Adhvaryu, Parker Howell, Anant Nyshadham & Jorge Tamayo.

Using administrative data from a large Colombian retailer and exploiting a manager rotation policy to estimate manager value-added, we study what good managers do and whether their impacts persist after they leave. Good managers increase sales by 12%, reducing stockouts while making inventory leaner, generating larger revenue gains from price changes without increasing the frequency of repricing, and shifting personnel attention toward back-office operations. When they depart, the staffing and inventory improvements persist, but pricing-related gains erode. These patterns reveal a fundamental distinction: some managerial contributions are embedded in organizational structure, while others depend on the manager’s ongoing, context-specific judgment.

VAT Holidays as Short-Term Economic Stimuli: Evidence from Colombia’s “Días sin IVA”

IDB Working Paper, 2024

with José Martínez-Carrasco, David Muñoz-Sánchez, Alejandro Rasteletti & Diego Zamora.

Using high-frequency transaction data and a repeated regression-discontinuity design across eight VAT holidays (2020–2022), we find that the policy raised sales in formal businesses by 15% net of intertemporal substitution, with substantial cross-sector spillovers—highlighting the stimulus potential of broad-based tax holidays in developing economies.

Teaching Experience

Harvard College

Teaching Fellow, Economics of Discontinuous Change (Econ 1818) 2024–2025

Harvard University – Division of Continuing Education

Teaching Fellow, Survey Research Methods 2022–2025

Teaching Fellow, Advanced Research Methods for Social Science 2022–2025

Harvard Kennedy School

Teaching Fellow, Advanced Quantitative Methods: Causal Inference (API-210) 2026

Tutor, Quantitative Analysis and Empirical Methods (API-201) 2025

Teaching Fellow, The Politics of Development (DPI-410) 2021

Teaching Fellow, Public Finance in International Perspective (DEV-215) 2020

Teaching Assistant, Advanced Markets and Market Failure (API-101Z) 2019

Research Grants

Weatherhead Center for International Affairs, Dissertation Writing Grant, Harvard

Kenneth C. Griffin Economics Research Fund, Harvard

Colombia–Santo Domingo Research Fund, Department of Economics, Harvard

DRCLAS Summer Research Travel Grant, Harvard

Ash Center for Democratic Governance & Innovation, Research Grant, Harvard

Harvard Kennedy School Summer Research Fellowship

Fellowships, Scholarships, and Honors

Dissertation Completion Fellowship, Harvard (Mildred Rendl PhD 1954 Fellowship)	2026–2027
Fulbright–García Robles Scholarship	2019–2021
Conacyt–FUNED Graduate Scholarship	2019
Comecyt Talent and Excellence Scholarship	2019
Dionisio Medina Harvard Scholarship	2019
Highest Honors, B.A. in Economics, ITAM	2018

Previous Professional Experience

World Bank — Consultant, Macroeconomics & Growth (DEC)	Washington, DC	2020–2021
Inter-American Development Bank — Consultant, Fiscal & Municipal Mgmt.	Mexico City	2018–2019

Skills & Personal

Software: Stata and Python.

Languages: Spanish (native), English (proficient), German (limited).

Interests: Marathon runner and open-water long-distance swimmer.

Professional Activities

Co-Chair, The MX Conference, Harvard Kennedy School	2021
Co-Organizer, The MX Conference	2020